Simon Kamau Gathu

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CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (SAA-C03) Amazon Web Services | 2026 | View Badge

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend & Cloud Engineer with 3+ years building scalable REST APIs, microservices, and cloud-native systems using Go, Rust, Node.js, and PHP. AWS Certified Solutions Architect (SAA-C03) with hands-on experience deploying and managing infrastructure on AWS (EC2, S3, VPC, IAM, CloudWatch). Proven track record delivering high-availability systems with sub-200ms response times and 99.9% uptime. Experienced in Docker, CI/CD pipelines, and infrastructure monitoring with Prometheus and Grafana.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	Go, Rust, JavaScript/TypeScript, Node.js, PHP
Backend	Gin, ActixWeb, Axum, Express.js, Laravel
Databases	PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis
ORM/Query	Prisma, GORM, Diesel, Sequelize, Eloquent
Cloud & Infra	AWS (EC2, S3, VPC, IAM, CloudWatch, RDS, ECS, Lambda, Route 53, Auto Scaling)
DevOps	Docker, Nginx, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Linux
Architecture	REST API, Microservices, Event-Driven, Multi-Tenant SaaS, System Design
Security	JWT, RBAC, 2FA, OAuth2, IAM Policies
Monitoring	Prometheus, Grafana, CloudWatch
Testing	Unit Testing, Load Testing (K6), TDD

WORK EXPERIENCE

TopStoneWriters Jan 2023 – Jan 2025 *Backend Developer (Contract)*

- Built RESTful APIs serving **200+ daily active users** for content management using Node.js and Express.js
- Optimized MySQL schema reducing query execution time by **45%** across articles, users, and transaction tables
- Integrated PayPal and M-Pesa payment gateways processing **$5K+ monthly** with **99.8% transaction success rate**
- Reduced API response time from **800ms → 250ms** via query optimization, caching, and database indexing
- Delivered weekly zero-downtime releases across Agile sprints, resolving **50+ production issues**

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Event Ticketing System **Github** Live Demo Nov 2024 – Present

- Deployed microservices platform on **AWS EC2** supporting **1,000+ concurrent users** with **99.9% uptime**
- Implemented JWT + 2FA authentication (email/SMS via Twilio) with secure session management
- Reduced latency by **60%** via connection pooling and query optimization under K6 load testing
- Integrated Prometheus & Grafana monitoring stack tracking **20+ KPIs** with real-time alerting
- Deployed with Docker + Nginx reverse proxy and AWS S3 for static asset storage

Mtaalink – Service Provider Platform GitHub May 2024 – Aug 2024

- Built high-performance Rust backend (ActixWeb) serving **20K+ monthly requests** at **<300ms p95 latency**
- Integrated **AWS S3** for scalable provider media storage (portfolios, images, videos)
- Designed PostgreSQL schema supporting **10,000+ provider listings** with optimized indexing
- Implemented rate limiting and caching mechanisms reducing operational costs by **35%**

EDUCATION

University of Nairobi Sep 2017 – Oct 2021
BSc Industrial Chemistry